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Ekam



Hospitality, disguised as solitude.

PROLOGUE

How to read this manual.

This is v2.0 of the Ekam Brand Operating System. It supersedes the previous Logo & Application Guidelines and consolidates the founder draft (v3.0) with the directional shifts proposed in v3.1. Where v3.0 and v3.1 disagree, v3.0 holds until founder sign-off on the v3.1 shifts.

Eleven volumes. The mark sits inside Volume IV — not at the front. The front is philosophy, audience, and the architecture of the brand itself. The mark serves; it does not lead.

Read slowly. The discipline is the product.

On materials. This document sets the *register* — local stone, indigenous hardwood, natural mineral wall finish, regional handwoven textile, oxidised iron, unfinished brass, hand-thrown ceramic. The **Sustainability Roadmap & Founder Letter** sets the *source* — which quarry, which mill, which forest, which weaver, which chain-of-custody, per site, per season. Where the two touch, the Roadmap governs. The BOS does not promise specific materials; it promises a register the Roadmap is responsible for filling.

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Volume I

Philosophy & Position

*The position the brand operates from. The decisions that earn the
right to silence everything else.*

CHAPTER 01 — MANIFESTO

A fixed text.

Ekam is the chance to stop scrolling past beautiful places and finally sit inside one.



Real landscapes. Real light. Real silence. Without the gloss of luxury or the burden of performance.



A stay is not a service to be delivered. It is a setting to be quietly maintained, while the guest does the work of being there.



We are a hospitality brand. We borrow vocabulary from luxury, wellness, adventure — but the centre of gravity is hospitality, in

*its oldest sense: shelter, warmth, food, a door that closes, a host
who knows when to leave.*



*The job is not to be the most expensive option in the forest. It is
to be the most considered one.*



*No two stays are the same. No two cabins are alike. Because no
two pieces of land are alike. We do not standardise the room. We
standardise the discipline.*

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The Singular.

CHAPTER 02 — THE STRATEGIC FRAME

Rich crave nature. Our advantage is the permissions.

India's wealth is climbing faster than its access to wilderness.

Money buys a better hotel. It does not buy a permit to build inside a buffer zone, on a forest department lease, on a tribal grant, on a single-track road that took five signatures and twenty years of relationships to earn.

That is our moat. Ekam exists where most hospitality cannot legally go. We do not need to compete on thread count or chandeliers. We compete on the door — and what the door opens into.

The job, then, is not to be the most expensive option in the forest. It is to be **the most considered one** — designed, hosted, and run with such care that the privilege of the location feels deserved by the guest, not flexed at them.

The permission moat is the brand.
Everything else is craft.

CHAPTER 03 — THE THREE PILLARS

Singular. Serene. Wild.

Every design and operational decision should carry at least one of these. If it carries none, cut it.

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SINGULAR

No two stays are the same. Every cabin, tent, or pod is placed with intent and designed around the land it sits on. Ekam is Sanskrit for the one — we build it into every detail.

शान्ति

SERENE

Quiet by design. Guests come for the long exhale, the cup of tea at 6am, the walk that leads nowhere and is the whole point. Our voice mirrors that calm.

वन्य

WILD

Every Ekam is off-grid, off-map, and on its own. We choose the hardest-to-reach places on purpose, because the reward of arrival is the entire experience.

CHAPTER 04 — THREE FOUNDATIONS

Three questions every decision must pass.

Before any decision — architectural, editorial, operational, commercial — three questions are asked. The decision must pass all three.

Does the land decide first, or are we forcing a design onto the site? If the answer requires us to reshape the land, the design is wrong.

02 **Is it operationally honest?**

Are we scrubbing the word luxury from guest-facing surfaces? Are we making staff work invisibly, or asking the guest to perform the work of being in a luxury hotel? Honest service does not announce itself.

03 **Is it silent?**

Are we removing what gets in the way? Every brand decision should subtract. Restraint is the discipline.

CHAPTER 05 — WHAT WE ARE / WHAT WE ARE NOT

A short clarification.

What we are

A hospitality brand in the oldest sense — shelter, warmth, food, a door that closes.

A network of singular cabins on land that other hospitality cannot legally access.

A host who knows when to leave.

The most considered option in the forest, not the most expensive.

A setting to be quietly maintained while the guest does the work of being there.

What we are not

A luxury brand. We borrow vocabulary from it; we do not centre on it.

A wellness brand. No retreats, no fasts, no transformation packages.

An adventure brand. No guided trekking, no off-road experiences.

A content brand. We post once a week, maximum.

A franchise. Each cabin is the first cabin again.

CHAPTER 06 — THE THREE TAGLINES

The brand's verbal logos.

Three lines. Each belongs to a context. Never shortened, paraphrased, or translated without design approval.

Hospitality, *disguised* as solitude.

COVER · HERO · MASTER EXPRESSION

No two alike.

SIGNATURE · TERMINUS · SINGLE-STAY FRAMING

The most *considered*.

COMPETITIVE FRAME · EDITORIAL · AGAINST LUXURY

CHAPTER 07 — WHAT WE WILL NEVER BECOME

A quarterly check.

Read this list every quarter. If we have started becoming any of these, the brand is in trouble.

- i.* A loud-luxury brand whispering expensively at \$2000+ a night.
- ii.* A wellness-content brand selling silent retreats, fasting protocols, or transformation packages.
- iii.* A franchise. Even one franchise dilutes the model irreversibly.
- iv.* A brand that posts daily on Instagram. Once a week is the maximum.
- v.* A brand that runs influencer campaigns. We do not pay for content.
- vi.* A brand that lists on Booking-style aggregators with discounted rates.
- vii.* A brand that offers experiences — guided trekking, cooking classes, photography workshops. The cabin is the experience.
- viii.* A brand that has a signature scent.
- ix.* A brand that has a customer-loyalty programme.

x. A brand whose owner is in the photographs.

Volume II

Audience

*Who we host. Who we don't. The three cohorts of one shared
psychological position.*

CHAPTER 08 — WHO WE HOST

The emotional driver.

Our guests are 22-to-45-year-old Indians and inbound travellers — curious, well-read, quietly exhausted by their city lives. They come from design, technology, media, finance, wellness, and independent practice. They buy less and feel more.

Beneath the demographic spread, our audience shares one psychological position: **they want a place that meets them as they are, not as their socials present them.** The Ekam stay is a permission slip — to be quiet, to be unobserved, to be a little less interesting in public for forty-eight hours.

The jobs they hire Ekam for.

- i.* Disconnect without unplugging the self.
- ii.* Be in nature without roughing it.
- iii.* Experience a place beyond the photos they have saved.

- iv. Feel transformed by Monday morning — but not in a way that requires telling anyone.

CHAPTER 09 — THREE PERSONAS

Three cohorts. One position.

The three personas map to the three tiers. Each books a different sub-brand. Each is met where they are.

PERSONA 01

The Weekend Seeker

27–34 · Books Kutir most often

WHO

Senior IC at a tech firm, early-stage founder, creative director, consultant. First-generation professional earning well, but quietly burnt.

INCOME

₹25–60L personal. Comfortable spending ₹9–14K per night.

TRIGGER

A brutal sprint at work. An argument. A birthday that crept up. A 3-day weekend they didn't plan.

FOUND AT

Instagram saves (not stories). Substack. Condé Nast Traveller India. Quiet travel Reddit.

DREAD

Resorts with piped music. Check-in queues. Pre-set activity schedules. A stranger's voice at 7am.

DECIDES

Scrolls in bed, books in 15 minutes if photography and copy feel right. Pays full upfront.

SUCCESS

Goes back to Monday feeling, in their own words, "like myself again."

PERSONA 02

The Conscious Traveller

32–42 · Books Shikhar

WHO

Senior professional, author, partner in a boutique firm, therapist, architect, independent consultant.

INCOME

₹45L–1.5Cr+. Willing to spend ₹18–25K per night when design and solitude are guaranteed.

TRIGGER

A quarterly ritual. A creative block. Finishing a project.
Processing a life event.

FOUND AT

Monocle, paper magazines, Paper Planes, Whetstone,
Tablet Hotels, word of mouth.

DREAD

Other guests' children. Mass-market wellness language.
Anything Instagrammable. Being sold to.

DECIDES

Researches quietly for days. Reads every line of the
site. Will email a real human before booking.

SUCCESS

Leaves having written, walked, or simply sat through
one full sunrise — and tells no one for weeks.

PERSONA 03

The Adventure Romantic

22–29 · Books Van or Kutir

WHO

Analyst, product manager, designer, junior associate,
independent content creator. Culturally online.

INCOME

₹15–35L combined. Aspirational ₹9–14K per night.
Saves for the right trip.

TRIGGER

Anniversary, birthday, promotion. Celebrating an external milestone, internally seeking quiet.

FOUND AT

Instagram reels and stories, Pinterest, calm YouTube travel, Spotify travel podcasts.

DREAD

Being overcharged for mediocre service. Unclear directions. Cabins that look different in photos than in person.

DECIDES

Couples decide jointly. Reads reviews closely. Values clarity on what is and isn't included.

SUCCESS

Returns with three phone photos they will print, one shared secret, and a plan to come back for Shikhar at 30.

CHAPTER 10 — WHAT UNITES THEM

A short statement.

They buy less. They stay longer. They want their hospitality soft and their adventure honest. They value clarity over cleverness, quiet over spectacle, and a good bed over any amenity on a brochure.

They are not booking a glamping weekend. They are booking **a better version of themselves for forty-eight to seventy-two hours.**

CHAPTER 11 — WHO WE DO NOT SPEAK TO

A short list. Strictly enforced.

- i.* Bachelor and bachelorette parties. Hen and stag groups.
- ii.* Wedding-photography parties. Pre-wedding shoots.
- iii.* Corporate offsites larger than eight people.
- iv.* Influencer campaigns. Content-creation residencies.
- v.* Anyone who asks for a discount in their first email.

*This is not snobbery. It is matching. The product is built for solitude,
and these audiences disrupt the experience for everyone else.*

Volume III

Brand Architecture

*One master. Four sub-brands as locked tiers. The names are
operational; the tier work is real.*

CHAPTER 12 — THE SYSTEM

Master + four sub-brands.

Ekam is the master brand. Beneath it sit four sub-brands, defined by tier. The tier is operational nomenclature — it organises pricing, materials, kitchen, and bathroom specifications. The tier name is never flexed in marketing copy. We never call Shikhar "luxury" on the website. We let the cabin do that work, and let curated platforms (Tablet, Mr. & Mrs. Smith) do the comparative framing.

SUB-BRAND	TIER	WHAT IT IS	RATE BAND
कुटीर Kutir	STANDARD	Hut. Stone floor. Wood stove. The most Ekam thing we make, at the most accessible price.	₹6–9K / night
वन Van	PREMIUM	Elevated platforms, woven tents, deep forest. The premium tier earns its price through proximity, not finish.	₹10–15K / night
शिखर Shikhar	LUXURY	Ridgeline cabins. Solid materials throughout. Earns its price through difficulty, not gloss.	₹16–25K / night

चाय

Chai

HOSPITALITY EXT.

Standalone cafés on the routes + in-house café at every Ekam property. The first Ekam most guests meet.

Per stop

CHAPTER 13 — SUB-BRAND SPECIFICATIONS

Each tier, by example.

KUTIR · STANDARD

Chitkul, Sangla, Pachmarhi. Hut, stone floor, wood stove. The most Ekam thing we make at the most accessible price. The brand reads through proportion, light, restraint — not the bill of materials.

VAN · PREMIUM

Baspa Valley canopy, Pachmarhi forest interior. Elevated platforms, woven tents. The premium tier earns its price through proximity, not finish.

SHIKHAR · LUXURY

Kalpa, Nako (3200m+), Spiti circuit. Ridgeline cabins. Solid materials throughout. Earns its price through difficulty, not gloss.

CHAI · HOSPITALITY

Nako, en route to Chitkul, in-house at every Ekam. Stone hearth, kettle that doesn't stop. Same menu, same ritual, same cup. The first Ekam most guests meet.

Tier is named operationally, not
flexed in marketing copy.

CHAPTER 14 — NAMING CONVENTIONS

Always Ekam first.

01 Three words, separated by the Bindu.

Always Ekam first, tier second, location third. Examples: *Ekam Kutir Chitkul*, *Ekam Shikhar Kalpa*, *Ekam Chai Nako*.

02 Spoken aloud as Ekam · Kutir · Chitkul.

The Bindu is the rhythmic pause.

03 Never skip a level.

Even internal ops documents follow the full lockup.

04 Location names in Inter 500, letter-spaced.

Never in the serif wordmark face on supplementary copy.

05 Never substitute a hyphen, slash, or pipe for the Bindu.

Only the clay dot bridges the words.

Volume IV

Identity

The mark, the type, the palette. The smallest weight in the system. The detailed logo specification is a separate companion document.

CHAPTER 15 — THE WORDMARK

E · KAM.

E · KAM

Bindu Clay dot between E and K, on cap-midline.

Set in Cormorant Garamond 400, all caps, with a clay-orange Bindu between E and K — vertically aligned with the cap-height midline. The Bindu is not decoration. It is the centre of gravity of the mark.

Five master files: wordmark cream, wordmark reverse, E-monogram, bilingual stack, Bindu solo. Internal teams may not regenerate from system fonts. Production files request from the Brand Hub.

Detailed clearspace, scale, misuse, and the social asset suite live in the companion Logo Specification.

CLEARSPACE

Reserve clearspace equal to the height of the letter E on every side. Nothing enters the moat.

BINDU

Always #B4613A. Diameter 13% of cap-height. Sits between E and K on the cap-midline. Never animates.

MINIMUM SCALE

24 px wordmark height on screen. 8 mm in print. Embroidered or engraved: 18 mm minimum.

LETTERSPACING

8% on screen at hero size. 1.5 mm at 30 mm height in print. Never closer than 4 px.

IN RUNNING TEXT

Set as Ekam. Capital E, lowercase remainder. The Bindu does not appear in prose.

Four faces.

DISPLAY

Cormorant Garamond. Light 300 / Regular 400. Wordmark, headlines, chapter openers, signage. Letter-spacing ≥ 4 px on headlines, ≥ 8 px on wordmarks.

STORYTELLING

Fraunces. Italic default. Storytelling, taglines, pull-quotes, email intros. Upright reserved for longer body. Line-height 1.55.

UI & METADATA

Inter. 300, 400, 500. UI, booking flow, way-finding, captions. Letterspacing 2–3 px on eyebrows. 0.5 px on body.

DEVANAGARI

Tiro Devanagari Hindi. Regular and italic. Welcome cards, cabin doors, wax seals, section dividers. Never substitutes for English UI.

Hierarchy.

- i.* Hero / cover: Cormorant 78–96 px, 14 px letterspacing.
- ii.* H2 section opener: Cormorant 38–44 px, 1 px letterspacing.
- iii.* H3: Cormorant 22 px, 1 px letterspacing.
- iv.* H4 / eyebrow: Inter 11 px uppercase, 4 px letterspacing, clay colour.
- v.* Body: Fraunces or Raleway 15–17 px, line-height 1.55–1.85.
- vi.* Pull-quote: Fraunces 21 px italic, 1.5 line-height.
- vii.* Caption / spec: Inter 12–13 px, 1 px letterspacing, moss colour.

The rule of saffron.

60% Cream / Sand · 30% Forest · 8% Ink · 2% Bindu Clay. Clay behaves like saffron in food — small quantity, unmissable presence. Never as wallpaper, never inside a heading colour, never as a button background.

Cream #FAF7F0 · 60%	Deep Forest #2B4630 · 30%	Forest Ink #14201A · 8%	Bindu Clay #B4613A · 2%
Sand #F4EDE1	Bone #ECE4D3	Mist #D8D3C4	Moss #7A8A6B

Four marks.

Each tier carries its own glyph, paired with the master wordmark and the tier name in Cormorant Garamond, all caps, letter-spaced.



कुटीर

KUTIR

TRIANGULAR
HUT ·
CHIMNEY



वन

VAN

THREE
CONIFERS



शिखर

SHIKHAR

THREE PEAKS,
SNOW CAPS



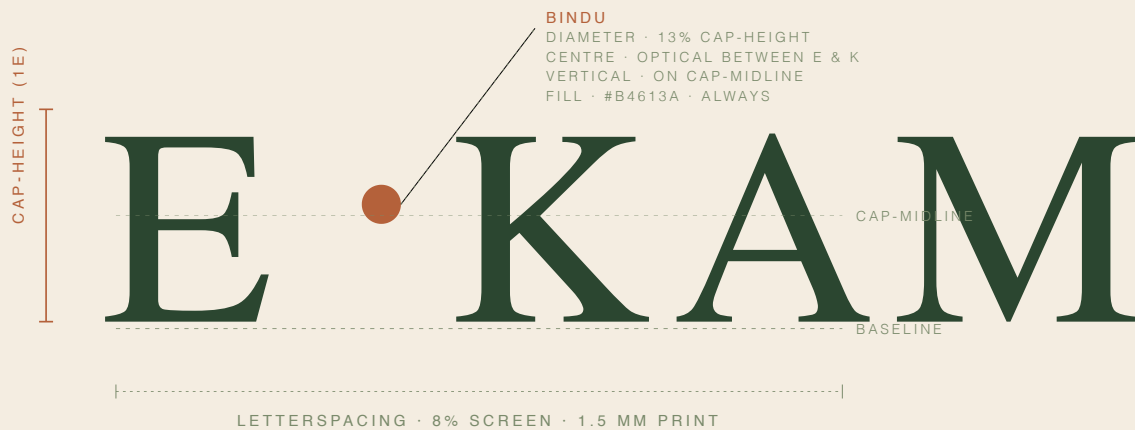
चाय

CHAI

KETTLE ·
TWO
RIBBONS
OF STEAM

CHAPTER 18A — WORDMARK ANATOMY

Construction, measured.



CHAPTER 18B — CLEARSPACE

The E-height rule.

Reserve clearspace equal to the height of the letter E on every side of the wordmark. Nothing enters the moat.

CLEARSPACE BOUNDARY · 1E ON ALL FOUR SIDES



CHAPTER 18C — REQUIRED ARTIFACTS

Seven master files.

Every application begins from one of these. Internal teams may not regenerate from system fonts.

E · KAM

E · KAM

E ·

E ·

Wordmark	Reverse	E-monogram	Monogram reverse
EKAM_Wordmark_Cream.svg	EKAM_Wordmark_Forest.svg	EKAM_Monogram_Cream.svg	EKAM_Monogram_Forest.svg
 Bindu solo EKAM_Bindu.svg	 Bilingual stack EKAM_Bilingual.svg	 Nav compact EKAM_Nav.svg	

CHAPTER 18D — MINIMUM SCALE

Where the mark stops reading.

MASTER WORDMARK

24 px screen · 8 mm print. Below this the Bindu collapses to a smudge.

E-MONOGRAM

32 px screen · 10 mm print. Profile pictures, app icons at small sizes.

BILINGUAL STACK

48 px overall · 16 mm print. Devanagari sets the floor, not the English line.

BINDU SOLO

16 px diameter · 4 mm print. Favicon, smallest app icon, wax seal, section break.

EMBROIDERED / ENGRAVED

18 mm minimum for the wordmark. Engraving below this loses the Bindu definition.

CHAPTER 18E — LOCKUP CONSTRUCTION

Three words. Two Bindus.

Every property reads as three words separated by the Bindu: **Ekam · Tier · Location.**

Same form, never reordered, never abbreviated.

EKAM · KUTIR · CHITK

WORDMARK FACE

Cormorant Garamond 400. ≥6 px letterspacing on screen, 1.5 mm at 30 mm height in print.

LOCATION FACE

Same as wordmark — Cormorant Garamond 400, same cap height as Ekam and the tier.

SEPARATOR

A single Bindu in Clay #B4613A, optical centre between words. Never two Bindus in one lockup. Never a hyphen, slash, or pipe.

SPOKEN FORM

"Ekam · Kutir · Chitkul" — the Bindu is the rhythmic pause.

CHAPTER 18F — SOCIAL ASSET SUITE

Thirteen named files.

Every public surface across X, LinkedIn, Facebook, WhatsApp, YouTube, and Instagram is covered by a finite, named-file inventory.

PROFILE · 06 FILES

Wordmark cream 1080. Wordmark forest 1080. Monogram E cream 1080. Monogram E forest 1080. Bindu only cream 1080. WhatsApp profile 640.

COVERS · 04 FILES

X header 1500 × 500 (wordmark left). LinkedIn cover 1584 × 396 (wordmark centred). Facebook cover 1640 × 624 (wordmark right). YouTube banner 2048 × 1152 (content inside 1235 × 338 mobile-safe zone).

Instagram post 1080 × 1080. Instagram story 1080 × 1920.

PROFILE ROTATION

Instagram — Monogram cream. Pinterest — Monogram cream. X — Monogram cream. Facebook — Wordmark forest. YouTube — Monogram forest. WhatsApp — Bindu only. Never the Bindu-only as a primary profile on a content platform.

CHAPTER 18G — YOUTUBE HALLMARK

The wordmark as on-screen signature.

Ekam Kutir Chitkul

A SPRING MORNING ON THE PORCH

E · KAM

POSITION

Bottom-right corner of frame. 4% of frame width padding from both edges.

SIZE

3% of frame width. Wordmark height ~24 px on 1080p video.

OPACITY

55–60%. Never opaque, never below 45%.

COLOUR

Reverse wordmark on dark frames. Master on light. Bindu always #B4613A at full saturation.

PERSISTENCE

Appears for the full duration of content. Not a fade in / out.

INTRO & OUTRO

Intro 0:00–0:02 — Bindu fade in (0.8 s), wordmark resolve, hold 1 s, cut. End screen 0:20 — Deep Forest, reverse wordmark centred, "No two alike." in Fraunces italic at 60% Sand opacity below.

CHAPTER 18H — PARTNER LOCKUPS

Three tiers. One wordmark.

TIER 01 · EDITORIAL

Mention only. Named in copy. No lockup, no co-located logos.

TIER 02 · CO-BRANDED

Adjacent lockup. Ekam wordmark + Bindu Clay hairline + partner mark. Partner ≤50% Ekam wordmark height. Ekam leads. Brand Hub approval.

TIER 03 · HOSTED

Full co-presence. Master wordmark always above. Partner at sub-brand weight. Production file from Brand Hub. Founder sign-off.

LEAD WITH LANDSCAPE

The partner's village or estate is named before Ekam is. The partnership is a credit, not a campaign.

NEVER

Set a partner at equal or greater visual weight than Ekam. Lead with the partner mark. Co-brand with sub-brand lockups — pairings always sit on the master wordmark. Place co-branded lockups on photography.

E · KAM | PARTNER

What we never do.

The list below is illustrative, not exhaustive. When in doubt, request approval from the Brand Hub.

01 **Do not float the Bindu above the K.**

The dot sits on the cap-midline, between E and K. Never above any letter.

02 **Do not recolor the Bindu.**

Always #B4613A. Never another colour. Never with opacity.

03 **Do not stretch, condense, or distort.**

Scale by wordmark height — never by container width.

04 **Do not substitute another typeface.**

Cormorant Garamond Regular only. Sans-serif system fonts violate the master.

05 **Do not place on non-canon backgrounds.**

Cream, Sand, Deep Forest, Forest Ink only. Never on Moss, Mist, or photography.

06 **Do not replace the Bindu with a symbol.**

Heart, leaf, flower, emoji, photograph — the dot is fixed in shape.

07 **Do not append marketing taglines under the wordmark.**

The three approved taglines are the only verbal companions to the wordmark, and they appear in specified contexts only.

08

Do not surface operational tier names in guest-facing lockups.

Standard / Premium / Luxury are backend only. Never in lockups, signage, or marketing copy.

09

Do not append descriptors below the wordmark.

"living", "retreats", "cabins" — pre-v3 forms are deprecated. The wordmark is complete.

Volume V

Place & Land

*The site decides first. Every architectural and material decision
begins with that fact.*

Site selection.

The land is not a backdrop. It is the project. We choose the site first; we design the cabin second.

01 Built area never exceeds 8% of acquired land.

For a 5-acre parcel, no more than 0.4 acres are built. The remaining 92% is left, restored, or actively rewilded. Non-negotiable.

02 The cabin disappears at 50 metres.

From any approach path at 50 m distance, a single cabin should not visibly read against the landscape. If it reads, the cladding, roof line, or siting is wrong.

03 One tree felled requires three planted.

Native species only. Planting within the same monsoon window as felling. Per-tree accounting, not per-canopy. Project lead signs the register before construction.

04 **No site requires removal of a perennial water feature.**

Streams, springs, ponds, seasonal water-paths are not redirected, capped, or built over. The cabin moves. The water does not.

05 **The approach is on foot.**

Vehicular access ends at the perimeter. The final approach is on foot — never a paved road to the door.

06 **Sites we do not build on.**

Floodplains. Migration corridors verified by a local biologist. Land within 200 m of a working village without the village's invitation. Sites whose principal view is another building. Sites whose principal sound is a road.

CHAPTER 20 — ARCHITECTURAL LANGUAGE

Single-room, single-window, single-view.

The architecture is foreground-first: a vessel built to direct attention to one window, one view, one place.

FOOTPRINT

One- or two-room cabins. Never more. A second room only if a partitioned sleeping space is required.

WINDOW

One large window per cabin, oriented to the primary view. The rest of the cabin is a vessel for that window.

ROOF

Pitch follows local vernacular — the regional building tradition for the elevation, climate, and material register of the site. Per the Sustainability Roadmap's site-specific spec. Never "modern cabin chic."

FOUNDATION

Foundation and stilts are visible. We do not hide structure behind cladding.

CEILING HEIGHT

3.5–4.5 m. Never lofted, never double-height. The cabin should feel held.

FIRST SIGHT ON ENTRY

The first thing the guest sees on entering is the window — never the bed, never the kitchen.

DISAPPEARANCE TEST

Before sign-off, the head architect walks 50 m from the cabin in three directions. Visible / invisible. Visible fails.

CHAPTER 21 — MATERIALS BY TIER

The honest compromise.

The standard tier admits the compromise rather than faking the spec.

SHIKHAR · LUXURY

Local stone flooring. Natural mineral wall finish. Indigenous hardwood joinery. Hand-thrown ceramic. Raw wool. Unfinished brass. Solid wood throughout. Every material is what it looks like.

VAN · PREMIUM

Indigenous hardwood throughout, per regional availability and the Sustainability Roadmap. Engineered wood only where solid would warp (wet zones, behind plumbing). Natural mineral wall finish. Local stone where the platform allows. Hand-thrown ceramic. Unfinished brass. The premium tier shows up in the immersion, not the surfaces.

KUTIR · STANDARD

Regionally available softwood or budget-permitting indigenous hardwood. High-grade engineered wood for cabinetry. Natural mineral wall finish. **Sealed acrylic wet-zone sheet** — named honestly on the spec sheet, never as "stone-effect". Locally fired ceramic. Brushed brass. The brand reads through proportion, light, restraint — not the bill of materials.

BANNED IN ALL TIERS

Painted MDF. Vinyl. Imported wall tile. Polished marble. Chrome. Plastic laminate. Shiplap. Anything pretending to be a material it isn't.

CHAPTER 22 — LIGHTING

Day, Evening, Night, Off.

Built around four moods and a single capacitive panel per cabin.

No electric lighting on. The window does the work. Unbleached cotton curtains, full-pull only.

EVENING

2400–2700K. Three sources only: pendant over the eating surface, wall sconce by the bed, lantern on the porch.

NIGHT

A single 1800K bedside source. No overheads after sunset by default. The wood stove is part of the lighting plan.

OFF

Everything off. The window does dawn.

CRI

CRI 95 minimum. We buy on quality of light, not lumens.

SMART PANEL

One capacitive smart panel per cabin: matte oxidised brass face, four etched zones (Day · Evening · Night · Off). Bulbs locked to 1800–2700K. RGB modes disabled at the controller.

FITTINGS

Unfinished brass or oxidised black iron. No exposed bulb filament unless the bulb is genuinely Edison-vintage and 10 W or less.

CHAPTER 23 — LANDSCAPE INTEGRATION

The garden is the forest.

There is no "landscape design" in the conventional sense. We do not plant ornamental beds. We do not lay turf. The garden is the forest the cabin sits inside.

01 **Native species only.**

Every plant on the property appears in the regional botanical survey within a 25 km radius. List signed by the commissioned biologist before planting.

02 **No lawn.**

Maintained grass is incompatible with the brand. Natural groundcover — moss, leaf litter, alpine grass. We mow nothing.

03 **Paths are felt before they are seen.**

Surfaces use the local material register. Edges are unmarked — the path is defined by the texture change underfoot.

04 **Water features are existing, never built.**

No constructed ponds or fountains. If a stream runs through the property, the cabin acknowledges it.

05 **No outdoor furniture beyond the porch.**

The land is not a beer garden. No benches scattered across the site. The porch is the outdoor room.

CHAPTER 24 — SEASONAL ADAPTATION

What changes. What never does.

The cabin reads the calendar. The brand does not.

MAR → MAY

Spring

First light returns. Windows open at midday. The kettle carries the season's botanical. Linens lighten to natural fibre, sand and cream.

JUN → AUG

Monsoon

The rain becomes the soundtrack. Linen replaces cotton. Hot ginger arrival. Dry-store menu per the regional pantry.

SEP → NOV

Autumn

Clearest light of the year. Wool throws return. The kettle carries the season's spice. Harvest menu peaks.

DEC → FEB

Winter

Cabin closes in. Fire central. Wool over flannel. Buttered chai arrival.

The season is not a campaign. It is a fact.

Volume VI

The Cabin · Offering

*The product the guest meets. Sleep is the non-negotiable. Everything
else serves it.*

CHAPTER 25 — THE DOOR & THRESHOLD

Sound of arrival is the sound of stones.

01 Gravel for the final 20 metres.

The final approach is on gravel. The sound of arrival is the sound of stones underfoot.

02 Cabin number hand-cut in local stone or unfinished brass.

≤40 mm tall, beside the door at hand height. Devanagari numerals.

03 Entry through a covered porch.

No glass airlock, no foyer.

04 Door swings inward, on visible black-iron hinges.

Outward swing fails on Himalayan exterior doors — wind catches, snow seals. Inward swing is the considered choice, not the default.

05 **Smart lock, visible.**

A considered IoT deadbolt in oxidised brass — Yale Assure or August in matte finish. Never plastic, never a touchscreen panel. Pairs with the guest's phone before arrival. A brass spare key in a stone niche on the porch.

06 **First thing seen on entering is the window.**

Never the bed. Never the kitchen.

CHAPTER 26 — THE ROOM

Furniture philosophy.

80% built-in. 20% movable. The cabin and the furniture are one piece.

- i.* **Built-in (80%):** window seat, bed platform, ledge desk, kitchen counter.
- ii.* **Movable (20%):** one low chair, one stool, one side table. That is the entire movable inventory.
- iii.* **Raw, not refined.** Saw marks visible. Joints visible. Fasteners not hidden.
- iv.* **No upholstered furniture** except the window-seat cushion.
- v.* **No coffee table.** The floor is the coffee table — a low cotton dhurrie, a wooden tray, done.

A good bed before any amenity on a brochure.

Sleep is a brand pillar. Continuous investment in mattress, linen, and sleep environment. The cabin is built around the bed before it is built around anything else.

THE PLATFORM

Mattress on a low platform, ≤ 30 cm off the floor. No bed frame with vertical posts. The platform is built into the cabin, not imported.

THE MATTRESS

Natural latex over coil, hand-tufted, breathable. Annual research investment. Replaced on hand-finish wear, not on time interval. *The mattress is the most expensive guest-touched commission per cabin after the outside-in audio.*

THE LINEN

Natural fibre, stonewashed, drawn from the brand palette. Default rotation: cream and sand. Deep Forest or Ink available on request, standing palette in Shikhar cabins. No synthetic blends, ever. Source per the Sustainability Roadmap.

THE LAYERING

Fitted sheet → flat sheet → light wool blanket → optional heavier throw at the foot. Region-appropriate handwoven wool and cotton, sourced per the Sustainability Roadmap.

THE PILLOWS

Two per person. **One firm, one soft** as the default — the guest picks their side. A third in-between pillow is in the cupboard for anyone who wants it. No decorative pillow stack.

THE BOOK

One book on the bedside, hand-picked per cabin and per stay. Annotated pencil left inside. The book is part of the bed.

THE LIGHT

A single 1800K bedside source within reach from the pillow. No overhead light in the sleeping zone. The window does dawn.

THE ROOM

Sleeping zone temperature held at 18–20°C. No HVAC drone — passive ventilation primary, supplemental only when the site demands. The bedroom is the quietest room: outside-in audio cuts at 22:00.

NO TURNDOWN

No staff turndown service. No chocolate on the pillow. No card with breakfast options. The bed is made before arrival and is not re-made until the guest leaves the room the next morning.

—

The guest leaves rested before they
leave moved. Sleep first.

—

The honest spec.

SHIKHAR · LUXURY

Local stone or fired clay floor. Natural mineral wall finish. No tile, no grout lines. Wet zone in stone with a stone drain.

VAN · PREMIUM

Local stone floor. Natural mineral finish on dry walls. On shower walls, stone where the platform allows it, sealed acrylic sheet elsewhere — per the Sustainability Roadmap site spec.

KUTIR · STANDARD

Sealed acrylic sheet on shower walls and behind sinks. Single-piece, matte, in a colour drawn from sand or mist — never glossy white, never fake-stone-print. The standard tier admits the compromise rather than faking the spec.

MIRROR

One mirror, framed in unfinished wood. Not backlit. Not fog-resistant. Not magnified.

SHOWER

Wooden plank floor with a stone drain. Open. No curtain. No glass enclosure.

SOAP & SALT

One refillable ceramic bottle of locally pressed plant-oil soap. One ceramic jar of bath salt. Hand-labelled. Nothing else. Sourcing per the Sustainability Roadmap.

PRIVACY GLASS

Smart frosted glass (PDLC film, switchable) on any pane facing a path. One control. Off by default.

CHAPTER 29 — KITCHEN BY TIER

Full kitchen in Shikhar only.

Full in-cabin kitchens live in **Shikhar** only. **Kutir** carries a kettle station and a pantry shelf, no stove. **Van** has a covered outdoor cook-platform shared with one or two neighbours. Across all tiers, Ekam Chai serves the warm meals.

STOVE

Two-burner gas stove (Shikhar only). Never induction. Visible flame, visible gas line.

KETTLE & COOKWARE

One brass kettle. One cast-iron pan. One ceramic pot. No gadgets, no toasters, no electric kettles.

PANTRY

Salt, sugar, ghee, two teas (one Indian estate, one regional herbal), local honey. Hand-labelled. Source per the Sustainability Roadmap's seasonal pantry register.

CROCKERY

Hand-thrown ceramic in moss or sand. **Two plates, two bowls, two mugs, two glasses.** Not four. Not six. Two.

CUTLERY

One knife. One wooden spoon. One brass strainer.

CHAPTER 30 — TOUCH & TEXTURE

Every surface natural.

Every surface a guest's hand meets for more than a moment must be natural.

Allowed

Wood (untreated or oiled)

Stone

Ceramic

Wool

Linen

Paper

Brass

Leather

Natural mineral wall finish

Banned in interior contact zones

Plastic

Vinyl laminate

Painted MDF

Glossy enamel

Rubber strips

Polished marble

Anything visibly synthetic

The deliberate exception: the smart switch panel — matte oxidised brass face, capacitive touch zones, etched not screen-printed. We treat it as a piece of brass that happens to be smart, not a screen that happens to be in brass.

CHAPTER 31 — CONSIDERED TECH

Visible. Smart. Disappearing.

Tech that disappears into materials. Not tech that pretends not to exist.

SMART LOCK

Yale Assure or August in matte oxidised brass. Visible. Pairs with the guest's phone before arrival. Brass spare key in a stone niche on the porch.

SMART PANEL

One capacitive panel per cabin: matte oxidised brass face. Four etched zones (Day · Evening · Night · Off). RGB modes disabled at controller.

E · KAM

BOS · V2.0

PDLC film on bathroom and path-facing panes. One switch, obvious. Off by default. The mirror itself stays analog.

APP DIMMING

App dimming is preferred over fiddling with three separate switches. The controller stays invisible. The bulb does the work.

OUTSIDE-IN AUDIO

Concealed dual speakers wired to external directional mics. Pipes the soundscape of the land into the cabin in real time. Cuts at 22:00.

FORBIDDEN

Plastic-bodied switches. Touchscreen panels. Voice assistants. In-room tablets. Hidden cameras. Smart appliances that beep or click.

Reference: Aesop, Le Labo, Frette.

Small, beautifully made, no logos shouting, no T-shirts, no hoodies, no mugs with cartoons of cabins. The opposite reference is the Starbucks tumbler — we do not do that.

01 Robe

Flax linen. No printed logo. A small Bindu hand-stitched at the hem in clay-orange thread.

02 Linen sheet set

Stonewashed cotton in cream, sand, deep-forest, or ink. Folded in unbleached paper, tied with twine.

03 Wool throw

Region-appropriate handwoven wool or hand-spun cotton. Hangtag is a single local-stone slab with the Bindu and the weaver's village hand-cut into it.

04 Hand-thrown ceramic

Mug, bowl, kettle. Single-Bindu base, undated, slightly different each batch.

05 Plant-oil soap & bath salt refill

The same one used in the cabin. Refillable ceramic bottle. No Ekam name on the label — only the soap-maker's village. Oil and salt source per the Sustainability Roadmap.

06 Match box

Cream card, black Bindu, lime-yellow interior. Functional first — strikes deliberately rough.

What we never make: mugs with the logo,
branded slippers, key-tags, water bottles, tote

bags with the tagline, T-shirts, hoodies, anything with a printed Ekam wordmark in primary view.

CHAPTER 33 — WELCOME RITUAL

First four minutes.

01 The card.

A handwritten card lies on the bed (not the table). Two sentences. Signed by the host with first name only. Re-written for each guest from a template — never photocopied.

02 The mug.

A copper mug of water and a sprig of fresh local botanical — chosen by the host from the site's seasonal calendar. Refilled daily.

03 The room.

The cabin smells like it has been aired, not perfumed.

The candles.

Candles unlit at arrival. Matches placed beside them. The guest lights the cabin themselves.

Volume VII

Wayfinding & Senses

*Sound, scent, sight, motion. How a guest finds their way through
Ekam.*

CHAPTER 34 — SIGNAGE

CNC hardwood. Iron inlay.

SUBSTRATE

CNC-routed indigenous hardwood — species per the site's regional register, governed by the Sustainability Roadmap. 25 mm thick. Hand-oiled finish. Oxidised iron standoffs where free-standing.

LETTERING

Cormorant Garamond Light 300. CNC-routed and inlaid with oxidised iron. Letter-spacing minimum 10 px. Never painted, never sandblasted.

DEVANAGARI

Tiro Devanagari Hindi, same iron inlay. Devanagari sits above the English on stacked plaques, never below.

NIGHT LIGHTING

None. Signage is read by daylight or handheld lantern. We do not backlight signage.

MAXIMUM PER SITE

Seven. Property entry. Parking terminus. Reception. Chai pavilion. Trail head (if present). Each cabin door. Register kept by the property manager and approved by Brand Hub before any new sign.

TO NE

Informational. Never persuasive. Says *Reception*, not *Welcome Home*. Says *Chai*, not *The Tea Pavilion*.

CHAPTER 35 — WAYFINDING

The path is the sign.

Ekam wayfinding does not run on arrows. A guest finds their way by the materials underfoot. When the surface changes, they have made a turn. When the surface darkens, they are nearing arrival. When the surface ends, they have arrived.

01 Material changes carry the wayfinding.

Stone → earth signals public to semi-private. Earth → gravel signals cabin approach. Gravel → stone-slab signals arrival.

02 Light marks the route at night.

Path lanterns at 1800K, low intensity, 8 m apart on the primary route only. Cabin approach unlit — the guest is given a handheld lantern from reception.

03 No maps in the cabin.

No printed property map. A hand-drawn map is offered at reception on request, drawn in Forest Ink on Cream paper.

04 Reception is the only point of orientation.

CHAPTER 36 — ENVIRONMENTAL GRAPHICS

A short chapter.

Ekam has no environmental graphics. The land speaks first.

No murals, decals, super-graphics, wayfinding installations, brand walls, photo-opportunity markers, or installed signage moments anywhere on Ekam property beyond the seven approved signs catalogued in Chapter 34. When a designer, vendor, or internal team proposes one, the answer is no. The proposal does not require review. It is declined at the brief stage.

The wall is already a graphic. We did not need to add one.

CHAPTER 37 — SOUND

The window is the stereo.

Outside-in audio is the brand's signature. Music is forbidden in the cabin.

OUTSIDE-IN AUDIO

Concealed dual-speaker configuration wired to external directional microphones. The microphones face the strongest natural soundscape — water, canopy, wind. Speakers pipe that soundscape into the cabin in real time, unedited.

INDOOR LEVEL

Set so outside-in sound reads at **−6 dB from normal speaking voice** at standing height in the centre of the cabin.

OFF-HOURS

System cuts at 22:00, resumes at sunrise. Sleeping hours are silent.

NO PIPED MUSIC

No speakers in the bathroom. No music on the porch. No music in the booking flow. No background sound on hover.

CHAI PAVILION

No music during peak quiet hours (6–8am, 4–6pm). At other times, a single album of locally relevant music — no shuffles, no playlists, no Spotify.

FORBIDDEN

Bluetooth, AUX, in-cabin speakers for guest music (small unit provided only on explicit request). Notification sounds. Appliance beeps. Smart lock click.

FRIDGE

The only allowed motor in the cabin. Specified for ≤ 30 dB at 1 m.

CHAPTER 38 — SCENT

Allowed, not designed.

If a guest opens the door and smells the place, we have done it right. If they smell a brand, we have failed.

DOCTRINE

Nothing piped. No diffusers. No HVAC scenting. No signature fragrance, ever. No essential oils on textiles. No scented candles. No aroma-marketing of any kind.

INCENSE

Not present by default. Available on request: a small ceramic bowl with a single stick of locally produced incense from the site's nearest artisan source.

WHAT CARRIES NATURALLY

The cabin's indigenous hardwood — different at every property. The wood stove smoke in cold months. Wool, the natural mineral wall finish, the stone — each has a faint own-scent. Local botanicals brought into the cabin once a day. The kitchen, when used.

The day we have a signature scent,
we have stopped being a place.

CHAPTER 39 — PHOTOGRAPHY

Documentation, not storytelling.

We show what is there. We do not style it. The land is the protagonist, not the cabin, not the guest. If a frame requires a stylist, it is not an Ekam frame.

What we shoot.

- i.* The land at dawn, dusk, and blue hour.
- ii.* A single cabin window glowing at night.
- iii.* Hands — pouring tea, lighting a stove, holding a kettle.
- iv.* Texture: bark of the regional hardwood, the natural mineral wall finish, iron weathered by hand contact.
- v.* Food in three-tier tiffins. Always with steam if hot.
- vi.* Porches, thresholds, doorways — the in-between spaces.
- vii.* Empty rooms. The cabin without a person in it.
- viii.* Weather as subject — mist, snow on the porch, monsoon at the window.

What we never shoot.

- i.* Guests with visible faces, looking at camera.
- ii.* Champagne, signage, fitness-style wellness imagery.
- iii.* Drone shots that flatten the land into a sales image.
- iv.* Bright, oversaturated colour grading.
- v.* Posed group shots, lifestyle content with models.
- vi.* The wordmark embedded into the photograph itself.
- vii.* The bathroom, the bed unmade, any operational backstage.
- viii.* Stock or composite imagery in any application, ever.

LIGHT

Available light only. No studio strobes. No reflectors larger than 60 cm.

GRADE

Saturation reduced 8–12% from camera default. Black point lifted no more than 5%. Whites pulled toward Cream, never #FFFFFF.

FORMAT

35mm full-frame minimum. Medium format preferred for editorial. Phone capture only for behind-the-scenes, never for publication.

LOGO ON PHOTOGRAPHY

Only on the darkest 30% of the frame, bottom-left corner. Reverse wordmark, 60–70% opacity, $\leq 6\%$ frame width.

—

If a frame looks like a Marriott Bonvoy ad, it is
wrong.

—

CHAPTER 40 — MOTION

Slow. Locked-off. One permitted Bindu event.

Motion is rare. When it appears, it follows the breath of the land — slow, deliberate, asymmetric. The Bindu does not animate. Anywhere. Except once at the YouTube intro — and that exception is reviewed annually.

WHERE ALLOWED

Website hero: a single 30-second locked-off video instead of a still — fog, embers, kettle steam. Looped, no controls visible. One single landscape video on Instagram, ≤ 4 times a year, never a reel.

WHERE FORBIDDEN

The wordmark never moves. The Bindu never pulses, fades, or transforms (the one exception: 0.8 s fade-in at YouTube intro only). No parallax scrolling. No hover micro-animations beyond a colour shift. No transitions longer than 200 ms.

EASING

Ease-out only. Cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.6, 0.2, 1) is canonical. Linear is forbidden — reads as machine. Bouncy is forbidden — reads as toy.

VIDEO PACING

Average shot length ≥ 6 seconds. No quick cuts under 2 seconds. Pans ≤ 2 degrees per second.

VIDEO HALLMARK

Reverse wordmark in bottom-right corner. 3% frame width. 55–60% opacity. 4% padding. Persistent.

Volume VIII

Rituals & Journey

*The pacing of a stay. The guest does not see the choreography. They
feel its absence elsewhere.*

CHAPTER 41 — FOUR RITUALS

Four moments. Four scripts.

ARRIVAL	The kettle ritual	Within 4 minutes of guest entering the cabin: host pours the seasonal arrival drink from the kettle into a ceramic cup, sets it on the porch table, steps back. Hot ginger in monsoon, mint in spring, cardamom in autumn, buttered chai in winter. The host does not narrate.	HOST
DAWN	The unannounced rise	No wake-up call. No bell. The cabin is silent until the guest moves. A flask of hot water on the porch — left at 5:30 by a staff member who does not knock.	STEWARD
BLUE HOUR	The fire	40 minutes before sunset, the wood stove is lit. In summer cabins where there is no stove, a porch lantern is lit. The guest is not invited; the guest is simply present for it.	HOST
DEPARTURE	The wax seal	Morning of departure, a hand-pressed wax seal is left on the porch — Bindu Clay wax stamped with एकम्. Inside, a single line in Forest Ink: a hand-drawn map of the route home, the seasonal greeting, no signature.	PROPERTY MGR

Rituals are never announced in advance. Never billed as "experiences" or "amenities".
Never opt-in / opt-out. Never repeat within a single stay.

Twelve moments.

From first read to homecoming card. Every touchpoint is shaped by the same gesture:
brief, unhurried, by a person rather than a brand.

01	First read	Brand encountered for the first time — website, editorial mention, photograph from a friend. The tone is set here.
02	Booking	Direct or via a small set of partner platforms. Two screens — dates and one human field ("anything we should know"). No urgency timers, no "5 others viewing".
03	Confirmation	Confirmation by a real host within 12 hours. Plain text. From a person, not an alias. Cabin name in full, dates, the seasonal greeting, the route note. No upsell modules.
04	The week before	A printed letterpress card arrives by post. A weather note, a single image, a phone number for any question. Directions PDF 3 days before. Day-before SMS.
05	The road	Chai pavilion on the route — if route conditions permit — is open for the guest. Identified by Chai sub-brand lockup. The kettle is on.
06	Arrival at parking	A staff member meets the vehicle. Bags are taken. The walk to the cabin begins on foot, by daylight when possible, by lantern when not.
07	The kettle ritual	See Chapter 41.
08	First night	The cabin is intentionally under-stimulated. No turndown service. No chocolate on the pillow. The bed is made; the fire is laid; the porch is open. The guest decompresses on their own pace.
09	The middle	A second meal — local, daily-changing, delivered to the cabin in the three-tier tiffin. The staff member who delivers does not enter the cabin unless invited.

10

The walk

A walk is offered, never required. The host walks first; the guest follows. Silence by default. The host speaks if the guest speaks.

11

Departure

The wax seal. Bags walked back to the vehicle. No farewell speech. The handover is short and sincere. No invoice in person — the booking already settled the bill.

12

Homecoming

A second letterpress card arrives at home 3–5 days after departure. A photograph from the stay — taken by staff, never the guest's face, never staged. The card closes the arc. One honest survey one week after.

CHAPTER 43 — CHOREOGRAPHY

The pacing of a stay.

NIGHT 01

Under-stimulated. Arrival ritual only. No meal in the cabin unless requested. Fire is laid; the guest lights it.

NIGHT 02

First cabin-served meal — tiffin from Chai pavilion. Walk offered. Wood stove restocked.

NIGHT 03+

Optional deeper involvement on request — half-day with the kitchen, longer walk with the host, session with a guest local artisan. Never solicited.

FINAL NIGHT

A single bound book left on the porch — photographs and writing from the season's stays. The guest reads it; the guest does not take it.

DEPARTURE

Wax seal. Unhurried handover. The guest leaves without transacting.

—

The guest's stay accelerates. Ours
does not.

—

CHAPTER 44 — UNIFORMS

Three roles. Three uniforms.

Staff are visible because they are present, not because they are dressed differently.

ROLE 01

Host

OUTERWEAR

Forest-tone woven wool overshirt.
Hand-finished iron buttons.

TROUSERS

Forest linen in spring / monsoon.
Wool in winter.

NAME PIN

Oxidised iron, first name only.

ROLE 02

Steward

APRON

Natural undyed cotton, ankle-length in the Chai pavilion.

SHIRT

Sand-coloured linen, untucked.

FOOTWEAR

Soft-soled leather. Silent on the porch.

ROLE 03

Property Manager

OUTERWEAR

Forest wool jacket. Structured but soft.

SHIRT

Cream cotton, collared.

DETAIL

A small Bindu pin in oxidised iron at the lapel — the only role permitted to wear the Bindu visibly.

Standing rules.

- i.* First name only on the name pin. Never first-and-last.
- ii.* No visible logo on any garment except the property manager's Bindu pin.
- iii.* Replacement on hand-finish wear, not on time interval.
- iv.* No tucked shirts. No polished shoes. No tie. No badge.
- v.* The uniform is laundered on-property in natural plant-based detergent and air-dried. No commercial laundry chemicals. Detergent sourcing per the Sustainability Roadmap.

Volume IX

Distribution

*The visibility play. List everywhere. Compete on no platform. The
OTA is a billboard, not a sales channel.*

CHAPTER 45 — OTA VISIBILITY PLAY

List everywhere. Sell nowhere.

We list on Booking, Agoda, MakeMyTrip, Airbnb, Tablet Hotels, and Mr. & Mrs. Smith. Pricing on OTAs is set 25–40% above category median for the region.

Goal is visibility — putting Ekam alongside the Aman, the Postcard, the Six Senses in the discovery feed of someone who has not heard of us. Goal is not acquisition by price.

The economic conversion happens on our own surfaces — direct booking, the journal, word of mouth.

OTA PRICING RULE

Our rate is the **highest** in our visible cohort, by design. If an OTA rate-parity clause is forced, we delist that OTA.

DIRECT RATE

Always the lowest available — never advertised as a discount. Phrased as "booking with us directly includes Ekam Chai service and ₹2K cabin credit."

DIRECT INCENTIVE

Complimentary Ekam Chai service. Late check-out. ₹2K cabin credit. A written welcome from the host. Never advertised on OTAs.

STAR RATINGS

Live on the OTAs that use them. Our own site carries journal essays, never star ratings.

REVIEWS

Encouraged on Tablet and Mr. & Mrs. Smith. We respond to none — silence is the brand.

POST-STAY

One written letter, one honest survey link. No re-marketing emails after.

The OTA is a billboard. The booking
is a conversation.

One image at a time.

01 **One image at a time.**

No carousels. No auto-play hero videos. No animated backgrounds.

02 **Booking flow: two screens.**

Dates, and one human field ("anything we should know"). Confirmation by a real host within 12 hours.

03 **The host's number is shown but not as the primary CTA.**

At one property the phone works. At fifty it doesn't.

04 **No reviews or star ratings on our own site.**

They live on Tablet and Mr. & Mrs. Smith. Our site carries long-form essays, in the journal section.

05 **Page weight under 500 KB.**

The site loads on the patchy mobile data of Chitkul.

06 **One action per screen.**

No modal stacks. No "for you" content. Two permitted notifications: booking confirmation and the homecoming card.

Forbidden patterns.

Urgency timers. "Only 1 left" warnings. Newsletter pop-ups. Onboarding tours.

CHAPTER 47 — DIRECT BOOKING

A quiet form. A real host.

TWO-SCREEN FLOW

Screen 01: dates + cabin selection. Screen 02: contact + one human field. Submit. Done.

CONFIRMATION

Within 12 hours, from a real host, by name, by email. Plain text. System serif. No HTML banner. From a person, not a brand alias.

PAYMENT

Full upfront on booking, refundable per the seasonal cancellation window. No deposits. No instalments. No financing.

NO PHONE TREE

If a guest calls, a host answers — or it goes to voicemail in the host's voice. There is no IVR, no "press 1 for reservations".

CANCELLATION

Seasonal — wider window in monsoon, narrower in peak winter. Communicated plainly. No "no-show" charges if the host is reached.

CHAPTER 48 — SOCIAL · ACTIVE

One post a week, max.

Active platforms: **Instagram, Pinterest, Substack, YouTube**. Posting is rare. The audience is found, not chased. If a feed is grown by an algorithm, it isn't us.

CADENCE

One post a week, max. Always a single still image. Never a reel.

CAPTION

The date and the location. Nothing else. No hashtags except **#EkamCabins**.

FORBIDDEN

Engagement bait. Polls. "Tag a friend who needs this." Reels. Stories more than once a day. Reposting guests' face photos. Influencer campaigns. Paid content.

PINTEREST

Three boards: Ekam Kutir, Ekam Van, Ekam Shikhar. Saves-based discovery — drives to journal essays. One pin per week.

SUBSTACK

EKAM Journal. Long-form essays, monthly cadence. Free only — no paid subscriptions. From the host or a guest writer, never from "EKAM Team".

YOUTUBE

Quarterly long-form. Slow shots. Hallmark in bottom-right. No reels, no shorts, no trending audio.

Profile asset per platform.

- i.* Instagram — E-monogram (cream).
- ii.* Pinterest — E-monogram (cream).
- iii.* X — E-monogram (cream).
- iv.* Facebook — full wordmark on forest.
- v.* YouTube — E-monogram (forest reverse).
- vi.* WhatsApp — Bindu only.
- vii.* Substack — E-monogram (cream).

CHAPTER 49 — SOCIAL · DEFENSIVE

Registered. Never posted.

Some handles exist only to deny impersonation. Defensive registration, full security setup, zero activity.

TIKTOK

@ekamcabins. Registered. Bio: "Off-map. Off-grid." Profile: Bindu. No videos. No follows. No engagement. Squatting only — posting contradicts doctrine.

THREADS

@ekamcabins. Bio matches Instagram. No posts.

TWITTER / X

@ekamcabins. Bio + profile only. Replies off. Public when content posture is locked; private until then. Impersonation defense.

LINKEDIN

Company page. Hiring posts only. No marketing content.

FACEBOOK

Business Page. Travel Company classification. Bindu profile. Defensive registration; minimal use.

WHATSAPP BUSINESS

Linked to main +91 number. Business Profile only. Auto-reply: "We respond to messages within 12 hours. Direct bookings via ekamcabins.com." Never used for bulk messaging.

SECURITY BASELINE

2FA on every account. Recovery email at hello@ekamcabins.com. Password vault offline. Backup codes downloaded. Brand-claim filed where squatted accounts exist.

Five messages per stay. No more.

CONFIRMATION

Within 12 hours of booking. Plain text. System serif. From a person.

DIRECTIONS PDF

3 days before arrival. Hand-drawn-feel map. Phone number for the host.

DAY-BEFORE SMS

Weather note. ETA confirmation. Two sentences.

POST-STAY LETTER

One week after. Written like a letter. One honest survey link. No re-marketing, no rate-card pushes.

FOUR-WEEK POSTCARD

A printed letterpress card arrives at home. A photograph from the stay (no faces, never staged). The card closes the arc.

NEWSLETTER

No. Quarterly host-letter only — single short page, on Substack, free.

Volume X

Operations

*Constraints. Sustainability. Governance. The discipline at the
smallest scale.*

Eleven rules. Each earns its place.

Constraints, not refusals. Each one earns its place because it makes the experience better.

01 **Wi-Fi at the Chai pavilion only.**

One reliable network at the property's Ekam Chai stop. Not in the cabin. Bandwidth is a privilege our locations earn through difficulty.

02 **No television, projector, or smart screen.**

Including in the bathroom mirror.

03 **No room service. No mini-bar. No in-cabin F&B programme.**

The kitchen (where present) is yours, not ours.

04 **No staff inside the cabin once you have checked in.**

The door closes. Housekeeping happens only on departure or by explicit request.

05 **No printed marketing.**

No flyer, no rate card, no laminated breakfast menu.

06 **No QR codes for marketing.**

Anything worth knowing is told in person. QRs only ever for utility (Wi-Fi credentials, lock pairing).

07 **No upsells. No experiences menu.**

No spa, no wellness package, no add-ons. The cabin is the experience.

08 **No music piped through speakers.**

Silence is the soundtrack.

09 **No artificial scent.**

No diffusers, no signature fragrance, no incense by default.

10 **No tourist info packets.**

No "things to do nearby". The place is the thing.

11 **Post-stay: one checkout note and one survey.**

Written like a letter. No re-marketing, no rate-card pushes.

CHAPTER 52 — SUSTAINABILITY

Operational, not promotional.

We do not market sustainability. We measure it, and we improve it. The day we run a sustainability campaign, we have stopped doing the work.

Carbon.

- i.* Solar primary across all properties — minimum 80% of electricity load by year three of operation.
- ii.* Wood stoves use locally sourced fallen wood only. Never live-felled timber. A documented chain-of-custody.
- iii.* Cabin construction uses $\geq 70\%$ local materials by volume — local stone, indigenous hardwood, natural mineral wall finish, hand-thrown ceramic. Species and source governed by the Sustainability Roadmap site spec.
- iv.* Carbon accounting per stay — published annually, never on the homepage.

Water.

- i.* Rainwater harvesting on every roof. Greywater recycled to garden / forest recharge wherever soil allows.
- ii.* Low-flow taps and showers as default. Pressure designed for stillness, not power-shower bombast.
- iii.* Drinking water from local source, filtered on-site. Never bottled. Glass carafe with a small clay disc on the lid.

Waste.

- i.* Zero single-use plastic anywhere on property — including back-of-house, including kitchen storage.
- ii.* Composting is the default for organic waste, fed back to the property's garden.
- iii.* Linens and textiles sent to local laundry partners — never industrial detergent, only soap-nut and cold wash.

Community & land.

- i.* Every property has a community fund — a fixed percentage of revenue (3% target, 2% floor) returned to the village or panchayat we operate within. Use is determined by the local council, not by us.
- ii.* Hosts and operations staff hired from within 20 km of the property where possible.

Paid above the regional median by a documented margin.

- iii. Local artisans (weavers, soap-makers, potters, masons) are named on the in-cabin store hangtags and in the journal. Never anonymised. Never undercut.
- iv. Land-use is regenerative or neutral. We do not clear forest. We restore. Every property publishes a habitat report annually.
- v. We do not host activities that disturb wildlife or local rhythms — no off-roading, no "adventure sports" packages.

CHAPTER 52A — THE SUSTAINABILITY ROADMAP HANDOFF

BOS sets the register. Roadmap governs the source.

This is the most important separation in the document. The BOS does not promise specific materials. The Sustainability Roadmap & Founder Letter is the canonical document on every material sourcing, carbon, water, waste, community, and chain-of-custody decision.

The BOS commits to a sensory and material **register** — what a guest sees, feels, smells, hears, and touches. Local stone underfoot. Indigenous hardwood overhead. Natural mineral on the walls. Hand-thrown ceramic at the table. Region-appropriate handwoven textile in the linens. Oxidised iron at the hand. Unfinished brass at the fire.

The Sustainability Roadmap commits to **source** — which species of hardwood, which quarry of stone, which artisan kiln, which mill, which weaver's village, which chain-of-custody, which carbon accounting per kg of material, which water budget per fixture, which composting plan per kitchen. The Roadmap is updated annually and per site.

Where the two documents touch, the Roadmap governs the specific. The BOS governs the experience.

MATERIAL DECISIONS

All specific material specifications — species, supplier, source radius, chain-of-custody — live in the Sustainability Roadmap. The BOS never names a specific timber, stone, or weave.

CARBON, WATER, WASTE

All operational targets, accounting methods, and reporting cadences live in the Roadmap. The BOS commits to the principle (60% solar by year three, rainwater harvesting on every roof, zero single-use plastic); the Roadmap commits to the figures and the timelines per property.

COMMUNITY FUND

The BOS commits to the principle (revenue percentage returned to local council). The Roadmap commits to the percentage by site, the council relationship, the use audit cadence.

ARTISAN REGISTER

Named in the Roadmap. Updated annually. Hangtags, journal credits, and in-cabin store labels draw from the Roadmap register — not from a BOS-side list.

CONFLICT RESOLUTION

If the BOS implies a material the Roadmap cannot source sustainably for a given site, **the Roadmap holds**. The BOS register adapts. We do not break the Roadmap to fulfil a BOS description.

SIGN-OFF CHAIN

Material register changes in the BOS require Tier 2 (Brand Director) approval. Source changes in the Roadmap require Tier 3 (Founder + Director) approval. The Roadmap sits operationally one layer down but is owned at the highest tier of governance because it is where the brand's hardest commitments are kept.

The brand is a contract with materials. The Roadmap is where that contract is signed.

CHAPTER 53 — GOVERNANCE · APPROVALS

Three tiers of approval.

Brand integrity is maintained by a clear chain of approval. Anyone may propose; approval lives at three layers.

TIER 01

Host

Day-to-day operations within the cabin and on the property. Welcome cards, menu rotations within the seasonal frame, minor maintenance.

TIER 02

Brand Director

All copy. All campaigns. All partner agreements. Pricing changes within bands. Identity and visual application questions. Vendor selection.

TIER 03

Founder + Director

New properties. New sub-brands or tiers. Removal of any constraint in Chapter 51. Hosted partnership tier. Any change to the wordmark,

Standing rules.

- i.* No constraint in this document may be removed without Tier 3 approval and a written rationale added to the revision log.
- ii.* No new sub-brand, tier, or property launches without Tier 3 sign-off, including written preconditions and a documented audit against this entire document.
- iii.* Every property opens with a Section-by-Section audit. Any deviation is documented and approved before launch.

CHAPTER 54 — PRE-LAUNCH AUDIT

Before opening any new property.

01 Spatial doctrine compliance.

Volume V audit — written sign-off on architecture, materials, lighting, landscape.

02 Sensory systems installed and tested.

Outside-in audio commissioned. Smart panel functional. Smart frosted glass on path-facing panes.

03 Constraints confirmed in writing.

Every constraint in Chapter 51 confirmed by the host and the Brand Director, in writing.

04

Sustainability live.

Solar live. Rainwater harvesting installed. Community fund agreement signed with local council.

05

Tier 3 sign-off.

Founder + Brand Director on the property's location-lockup name and tier classification.

Before launching any campaign, copy, or partnership.

- i.* Voice check — read every sentence aloud. If it has an exclamation mark, rewrite. If it uses "luxury", rewrite.
- ii.* Restricted-applications check — visual identity.
- iii.* Partner rules — partner logo size, attribution language, photography register.
- iv.* Tier 2 (Brand Director) sign-off.

CHAPTER 55 — PARTNERS

Three tiers. One wordmark.

TIER 01 · EDITORIAL

Mention only. The partner is named in copy. No lockup, no co-located logos.

TIER 02 · CO-BRANDED

Adjacent lockup. Ekam wordmark + Bindu Clay hairline + partner mark. Partner sized at $\leq 50\%$ of Ekam wordmark height. Ekam always leads. Brand Hub approval required.

TIER 03 · HOSTED

Full co-presence. Kitchen residencies, in-cabin collaborations. Master wordmark always above. Partner reads at sub-brand weight at the entry point. Founder sign-off required.

LEAD WITH THE LANDSCAPE

The partner's village or estate is named before Ekam is. The partnership is a credit, not a campaign.

NEVER

Set a partner at equal or greater visual weight than Ekam. Lead with the partner mark. Co-brand with sub-brand lockups — pairings always sit on the master wordmark. Place co-branded lockups on photography.

CHAPTER 56 — VENDOR PASSPORT

The materials register.

Every supplier signs the same passport before any production order ships.

Stone, wood, and primary cladding materials sourced within 50 km of the destination site. Documented at the quarry / mill / forest. Site lead countersigns the source.

02 **No-plastic clause.**

Supplier commits in writing that no plastic — visible, hidden, or transitional — is used in delivered product. Plastic packaging from upstream supply must be removed before delivery.

03 **Hand-finish tolerance.**

Where a material is hand-finished, production tolerances follow craft, not industrial standards. Variance welcomed; uniformity is suspicious. We do not return work for being imperfect.

04 **Labour conditions.**

Every supplier provides a labour audit on annual cadence — fair wage, no child labour, no bonded labour, working conditions documented.

05 **The materials register.**

Every approved supplier sits in the Brand Hub's materials register. Reviewed quarterly. Suppliers who shift practices below standard are removed within one quarter.

06 **Right of refusal.**

Ekam reserves the right to refuse a shipment that does not meet specification. The supplier replaces, at the supplier's cost. Built into every PO.

**The brand is a contract with
materials, not a contract with
marketing.**

Volume XI

Evolution

*What may change. What never does. The framework that survives
v3.1, v3.2, eventually v4.0.*

CHAPTER 57 — THINGS THAT MAY CHANGE

Operational. Sensory. Pricing.

- i.* Operational tactics — booking flows, OTA partnerships, host training, kitchen menus.
- ii.* Pricing bands as rupee values shift — but always preserving the 25–40% above-category OTA premium.
- iii.* New tiers — only via Tier 3 approval, with written preconditions met fully.
- iv.* Sensory specifics — the local herb in the welcome mug, the album that plays at Ekam Chai outside peak quiet hours.
- v.* Material specifications when local availability changes — but never the tier hierarchy or the "banned in all tiers" list.

CHAPTER 58 — THINGS THAT NEVER CHANGE

Locked.

- i.* The wordmark. The Bindu. The clay-orange #B4613A. The three taglines.
- ii.* The strategic frame: rich crave nature, our advantage is the permissions.
- iii.* The three pillars: Singular, Serene, Wild.
- iv.* The four sub-brands and their tier roles — Kutir Standard, Van Premium, Shikhar Luxury, Chai Hospitality extension.
- v.* The eleven constraints in Chapter 51.
- vi.* The doctrine that we list on OTAs but compete on none.
- vii.* The architectural language: single-room, single-window, single-view; ceilings 3.5–4.5 m; door swings inward; smart lock visible, brass, not plastic.
- viii.* Sleep as a brand pillar.
- ix.* The three personas and the anti-audience list.

CHAPTER 59 — REVISION LOG

From v1.0 to here.

v 1.0	Initial brief. Original positioning. Exclusive language. Single-region.
v 2.0	"From seeing to being there." Three sub-brands defined. Two regions live.
v 2.1–2.4	Application system. Refusals reframed as constraints. Tier framing locked. Chai added. Formal logotype section. OTA strategy clarified as visibility play.
v 3.0	Founder draft. Full operating system. Philosophy, sensory systems, sustainability, governance, scalability, evolution framework. Tier framing canon: Kutir Standard, Van Premium, Shikhar Luxury.
v 3.1	Proposed directional shifts: sub-brands as geographic typology, not tier; Arrival Relief services; Sleep as pillar; central kitchen; spatial doctrine softened. Founder sign-off pending on six shifts. v3.0 holds where the two

disagree.

v 2.0 (BOS)

This document. v3.0 canon plus the v3.1 Sleep pillar carried forward. Eleven volumes. The mark moved out of the front position. Audience volume added. Distribution volume added. Considered Tech doctrine reconciled.

Annexure A

Environmental Artifacts

*Fifteen named physical objects that carry the brand across a site. A
reference catalogue for architects, contractors, and procurement.*

PREFACE TO THE ANNEXURE

What this catalogue is.

This annexure is the physical companion to Volume IV (Identity) and Volume VII (Wayfinding & Senses). It names the fifteen artifacts the brand commits to building, and sets the specification each must satisfy. The doctrine here is identical to the rest of the document: register, not source. Substrates appear as *local stone*, *indigenous hardwood*, *oxidised iron* — never as a named species, quarry, or supplier. Source is governed by the Sustainability Roadmap.

The catalogue is finite. Across an entire Ekam property — Kutir, Van, Shikhar, or Chai — these fifteen artifact types are the only environmental graphics permitted, beyond the seven approved signs catalogued in Chapter 34.

Per artifact: role, substrate, lettering, dimensions, lighting, placement, approval tier, and the constraint list. Read each as a build spec.

ARTIFACT A1 — ARRIVAL MONOLITH

The property's birth-mark.

The first thing the guest meets. A single standing object at the property line. The transition from public to hosted.

The Arrival Monolith is the most ceremonial physical object in the brand. It marks where the road ends and Ekam begins. From this object onwards, the approach is on foot, by daylight or by lantern. The monolith carries the property's full three-word lockup and nothing else. It is signed off at Tier 3.

SUBSTRATE

A single piece of **local stone**, dressed but not polished. Or, alternatively, a vertical column of **indigenous hardwood**, set into a stone base. Species and quarry per the Sustainability Roadmap site spec.

DIMENSIONS

1200–1600 mm tall × 320–400 mm wide × 220–280 mm deep. Taller on exposed approaches, shorter on close ones.

LETTERING

The property's full three-word lockup — *EKAM · TIER · LOCATION*. CNC-routed and oxidised-iron-inlaid. Cormorant Garamond Light 300, letter-spacing 12 px equivalent in mm.

LIGHTING

A single floor-set lantern at **1800K**, set into the ground to wash the monolith from below at night. Never backlit. Never spot-lit from above.

PLACEMENT

At the parking terminus. The guest steps out of the vehicle and meets the monolith. The vehicle stops at the stone behind it.

APPROVAL

Tier 3 — Founder + Brand Director. Every site is signed off individually.

NEVER

Polished. Cast. Carrying a tagline. Lit from above. More than one per property.

ARTIFACTS A2 — A15

The catalogue.

Fourteen further artifacts. Each carries the same discipline as the Monolith, at the appropriate weight.

ARTIFACT A2

Property Marker

A secondary marker at any non-primary entry.

ROLE

Identifies any subsidiary path or gate that joins the property — a village footpath, a forest department track, a back-of-house service road. Carries the master wordmark only; the full lockup lives on the Monolith.

SUBSTRATE

Local stone block or oxidised iron post. Per the Sustainability Roadmap site spec.

LETTERING

EKAM wordmark only. CNC-routed and iron-inlaid. Cormorant Garamond 400.

DIMENSIONS

600–900 mm tall × 180–240 mm wide.

PLACEMENT

All secondary entries. Maximum three per property.

APPROVAL

Tier 2 — Brand Director.

ARTIFACT A3

Trail Signage

Rare. Most trails are unmarked, deliberately.

ROLE

Where a trail joins another or where safety requires it, a small marker is permitted. Most trails are not marked. The land does the work.

SUBSTRATE

A single piece of oxidised iron, ground-set. Carries the property's typology pictogram (Kutir hut, Van conifers, Shikhar peaks) and a single directional cue — never an arrow, but a notched edge or a sloped face.

DIMENSIONS

180–240 mm × 100–140 mm.

LETTERING & LIGHTING

No lettering. No lighting.

PLACEMENT

Trail junctions and safety-required moments only.

APPROVAL

Tier 2.

ARTIFACT A4

Cabin Numbering

*Devanagari at the door. Latin
nowhere else.*

ROLE

Identifies the cabin at the door. Per Chapter 25 — Latin numerals appear in operational documents only.

SUBSTRATE

Local stone slab or oxidised iron plate, set into the door substrate. Per the Sustainability Roadmap.

LETTERING

Devanagari numerals (०१, ०२, ०३...), hand-cut. Tiro Devanagari Hindi typeface as the cutting reference.

DIMENSIONS

≤40 mm tall. Beside the door at hand height.

LIGHTING

None. The cabin is found by the path, not by a number visible at night.

APPROVAL

Tier 2.

ARTIFACT A5

Directional Totems

Used only where material change cannot do the work.

ROLE

Standing markers at decision points along longer property paths. Used only where the path forks at distance from the cabin and the wayfinding cannot be carried by material change alone.

SUBSTRATE

Indigenous hardwood post, square-section, with an oxidised iron cap. Per Sustainability Roadmap.

DIMENSIONS

900–1100 mm tall × 100 mm × 100 mm.

LETTERING

Destination name in Cormorant Garamond, CNC-routed and iron-inlaid. No arrow — the totem face *is* the direction. The guest reads orientation by the face that holds the name.

PLACEMENT

Path forks at >150 m from the cabin. Below that distance, material change carries the wayfinding.

APPROVAL

Tier 2.

ARTIFACT A6

Silent Markers

Carry no text. Mark presence, not direction.

ROLE

A silent marker tells the guest "you are here, on purpose." It does not direct or label. The Japanese reference is the *tsukubai* — a placed stone that is acknowledgement, not instruction.

SUBSTRATE

A single stone (50–200 mm in scale), a hand-marked tree, a length of natural-fibre cord tied at a height. Per Sustainability Roadmap.

PLACEMENT

Three to five per property. Placed by the property manager during a site walk with the Brand Director.

APPROVAL

Tier 3. Silent markers are the most subtle artifact in the system and the easiest to over-deploy. Tier 3 holds the count down.

NEVER

More than five per property. Reproduced from a kit. "Curated" by an outside consultant.

ARTIFACT A7

Ritual Spaces

Materially defined. Never signposted.

ROLE

The physical spaces where the four rituals (kettle, dawn flask, fire, departure) occur. Per Chapter 41 — these are not signed. They are materially defined.

SUBSTRATE

A single stone or worn-wood bench for the kettle. A ring of stones for the fire. A small ledge in the cabin wall for the wax seal.

MARKER

The material itself — a stone darker than the surrounding ground, a bench worn smooth where the host pours the kettle. The space is recognised by its texture, not its label.

LIGHTING

As per the ritual's hour. The fire space is lit by its own fire.

APPROVAL

Tier 3.

ARTIFACT A8

Tea House Markers

The Chai pavilion's own signage.

ROLE

Identifies the Ekam Chai pavilion — both the route-side standalone and the in-house pavilion at every Ekam property.

SUBSTRATE

Oxidised iron plate, indigenous hardwood mounting. Carries the Chai sub-brand glyph (kettle with two ribbons of steam) and the word CHAI in Cormorant Garamond, CNC-routed and iron-inlaid.

DIMENSIONS

400–600 mm wide × 240–320 mm tall.

LIGHTING

Lit by the pavilion's own interior light through the window at night. Never spot-lit.

PLACEMENT

One at the pavilion entry. One on the route-side facing the road for standalone Chai stops.

APPROVAL

Tier 2.

ARTIFACT A9

Parking Signage

The vehicle stops here. The guest understands.

ROLE

The terminus where vehicles stop and the approach becomes on-foot. A single marker, no text. The Monolith stands beyond.

SUBSTRATE

A single piece of local stone, ground-set. Per Sustainability Roadmap.

DIMENSIONS

400–600 mm tall × 200–280 mm wide.

LETTERING

None. The marker's position and the path beyond it carry the meaning.

LIGHTING

None. The path lantern (Artifact A14) carries the night.

APPROVAL

Tier 2.

ARTIFACT A10

Landscape Wayfinding

*Not a signage artifact. A
landscape-architecture
commitment.*

ROLE

The material register underfoot — stone, earth, gravel — carries the wayfinding across the property. Per Chapter 35.

TRANSITIONS

Stone → earth signals public to semi-private. Earth → gravel signals cabin approach. Gravel → stone-slab signals arrival at the threshold.

SUBSTRATE

Local materials per the Sustainability Roadmap site spec. Edges are unmarked — the path is defined by texture change underfoot, not by borders or edging.

APPROVAL

Tier 3. Any change to material transitions across the property.

NEVER

Edged. Paved with imported stone. Lined with garden borders.

Room Identity Plates

*The full lockup, inside the cabin,
beside the door.*

ROLE

A single plate inside the cabin, beside the door (interior side), carrying the property's full three-word lockup. The plate is the only place inside the cabin where the brand wordmark appears in physical form.

SUBSTRATE

Indigenous hardwood with oxidised iron inlay. Hand-finished. Per Sustainability Roadmap.

DIMENSIONS

120 mm × 60 mm.

LETTERING

EKAM · TIER · LOCATION — the full lockup. Cormorant Garamond. CNC-routed, iron-inlaid.

PLACEMENT

Interior wall, beside the cabin door, hand height.

APPROVAL

Tier 2.

ARTIFACT A12

Emergency Signage

Where code requires. Never decorated.

ROLE

Fire exit, fire equipment, first aid, evacuation route. Strictly compliance-driven. Where local code does not require it, it does not appear.

SUBSTRATE

Oxidised iron plate. The required pictogram per local code (IS 9457 in India), routed not painted.

LETTERING

As required by local code. Never decorated, never re-set in Cormorant Garamond. The compliance face is the compliance face.

LIGHTING

Self-luminous where code requires. Otherwise unlit.

PLACEMENT

Per code. Brand Director countersigns the local code-compliance officer's plan.

APPROVAL

Tier 2.

ARTIFACT A13

Service Access Signs

Back-of-house. Inconspicuous.

ROLE

Internal signage for staff only — kitchen pavilion, laundry, generator, water tank, supply store. Never on a guest-visible path.

SUBSTRATE

A simple oxidised iron plate. No inlay. Per Sustainability Roadmap.

LETTERING

The word in Inter 500, painted in Forest Ink ink. Functional first.

DIMENSIONS

100 mm × 60 mm.

LIGHTING

None.

PLACEMENT

At service entrances, visible only from the service path.

APPROVAL

Tier 1 (Host) for routine. Tier 2 for new locations.

ARTIFACT A14

ROLE

Night Navigation

Path lanterns. The cabin approach is unlit by design.

Marks the route from parking terminus to the Chai pavilion and to the property's reception. Per Chapter 35.

SUBSTRATE

Indigenous hardwood post or oxidised iron column, with a hand-blown glass lantern at the top. Inside the lantern, a 1800K source. Per Sustainability Roadmap.

DIMENSIONS

600–900 mm tall. Spacing 8 m on the primary route.

LIGHTING

1800K, low intensity, dusk-to-dawn auto.

PLACEMENT

Primary route only. Cabin approach is unlit by design — the guest carries a hand lantern from reception.

APPROVAL

Tier 3 — Founder + Brand Director.

NEVER

LED strips. Solar garden lights from a catalogue. Lighting on the cabin approach.

ARTIFACT A15

Pathway Markers

ROLE

*Presence-markers along longer
property paths.*

Occasional stone milestones placed along longer property paths. They carry the property's typology pictogram — Kutir hut, Van conifers, Shikhar peaks — carved into the stone face. Not arrows; not directions. They are presence-markers: "you are still in Ekam".

SUBSTRATE

A single piece of local stone, half-buried. The typology pictogram hand-carved into the visible face. Per Sustainability Roadmap.

DIMENSIONS

200–400 mm visible above ground.

PLACEMENT

One per 200–300 m of property path. Placed by the property manager during the site walk.

APPROVAL

Tier 2.

ANNEXURE GOVERNANCE

Maintained by the Brand Hub.

The artifact register for every site is held by the Brand Hub. Each artifact, on commissioning, is photographed, dimensionally documented, and signed by the

property manager and the Brand Director. The register is reviewed quarterly. Material specifications cross-reference the Sustainability Roadmap site spec — substrates are categorical here; sources are named there.

The fifteen artifact types in this annexure are the closed set. New artifact types require Tier 3 approval and an addendum to this document. They are not added by default; the discipline of the catalogue is its closure.

Fifteen artifacts. Closed set. New ones require a
Tier 3 amendment to this annexure.

Environmental & Spatial Signage System

Eleven doctrines. Each one is a rule every artifact in Annexure A obeys. Together they are what makes the catalogue read as one brand instead of fifteen objects.

PREFACE TO ANNEXURE B

A and B together are the system.

Annexure A names the fifteen artifacts. Annexure B names the physical behaviour every artifact must satisfy — how it ages, where it sits, how it relates to terrain, how it

reads at distance, how it handles light at night, how typography scales, how it weathers across seasons, how it mounts to the ground, how it yields to nature, how it carries script in multiple languages, how it behaves under headlight.

Neither annexure stands alone. A without B is a catalogue of objects; B without A is a set of principles with nothing to apply them to. Together they are the environmental design system. Together they are the part of the brand that contractors, architects, signmakers, masons, carpenters, and smiths build to.

Eleven doctrines. Each in this annexure carries: *principle* — the line that captures the rule, *rules* — the concrete operating spec, *cross-references* — which Annexure A artifacts it governs, and a *never* list.

DOCTRINE B1 — MATERIAL AGING

We do not protect materials. We choose materials that age well, and we let them age.

This is the most contested doctrine in the system. A vendor will always offer to seal, lacquer, refinish, "protect". The answer is no. The patina is the record of guests passing.

IRON

Oxidises in place. **No seal. No lacquer. No re-paint.** The patina darkens with hand contact at the Monolith over five years; this darkening is the brand's record of guests passing.

HARDWOOD

Silvers under sun and rain. **No re-stain. No re-oil on calendar.** Re-oiling occurs only when surface texture begins to crack — not on schedule.

STONE

Darkens with rain, accumulates lichen, holds moss. **No power-wash. No seal.** A stone that has lived ten seasons looks like a stone that has lived ten seasons.

BRASS

Dulls at hand-contact zones. **The kettle handle wears bright; the surrounding body dulls.** This contrast is intended and never corrected.

GLASS

Hand-blown lantern glass may craze over decades. Replace only when light transmission falls below 60% — never for aesthetic reasons.

GOVERNS

A1 Monolith. A2 Property Marker. A3 Trail Signage. A5 Directional Totems. A8 Tea House Markers. A11 Room Identity Plates. A14 Night Navigation. A15 Pathway Markers.

NEVER

Power-wash, sandblast, refinish on calendar, return a weathered artifact to "new" appearance.

A new-looking Monolith on a ten-year-old property is a sign that

someone has refinished it. We do not
do this.

DOCTRINE B2 — PLACEMENT LOGIC

Where the guest needs the answer
— not where the building wants
the credit.

*Every artifact answers a question the guest is about to ask, in the
moment they are about to ask it.*

HUMAN PACE

Artifacts sit where the guest naturally slows. The Monolith stands where the guest first steps out of the vehicle. The cabin number sits at hand height, beside the door, not above it.

DECISION-POINT ONLY

A sign appears at a fork, a threshold, or a hand. **Never on a long stretch of path** where the path itself is the only direction.

OUT OF THE VIEW

An artifact placed against the line of view to the primary landscape feature is in the wrong place. Where the cabin looks, no totem stands.

ORIENTED TO THE PATH

Not to the photograph. We do not place artifacts for Instagram angle. The face the guest sees is the face that does the work.

DELIBERATE EMPTINESS

The space around an artifact reads as intended. A Monolith with shrubs planted around it is no longer a Monolith — it is a garden feature.

GOVERNS

Every artifact in Annexure A. Placement is approved at Tier 2 on site walk, before the artifact is commissioned.

NEVER

Signage placed for photograph. Signage placed in the line of view. Signage at uniform decorative spacing along a path.

DOCTRINE B3 — TERRAIN INTEGRATION

The terrain decides the artifact's stance.

The artifact adapts to the ground. The ground does not adapt to the artifact.

SETS INTO SLOPE

The Monolith sets into the natural slope of the ground. **We do not level a pad for it.** If the site is steep, the Monolith tilts with the site, within 4° of vertical.

HALF-BURIED STONE

Stone artifacts (Pathway Markers, Parking Signage, Silent Markers) are half-buried. The buried portion is structural. The visible portion is presence. The transition between the two is not finished — it is part of the artifact.

PATHS BEND, NOT ROOTS

Where a path crosses an outcrop, the path bends. Where a path crosses a root system, the path passes between roots. We do not cut.

NO RETAINING WALLS BEHIND SIGNAGE

Retaining walls "set off" signage. We do not do this. The signage stands in whatever ground it sits in.

SLIGHT CANT PERMITTED

Where the site is steep, an artifact may sit at a slight, deliberate cant. The cant is part of the integration — never corrected with shims.

GOVERNS

A1 Monolith. A5 Directional Totems. A9 Parking Signage. A14 Night Navigation. A15 Pathway Markers.

NEVER

Flatten ground for a sign. Retain a wall behind a sign. Place a sign on a poured plinth. Shim an artifact to perfect vertical.

Each artifact is sized for its read distance.

Not for visual prominence. Not for marketing reach. For the distance at which the guest needs to read it.

Read distance per artifact.

A1 Monolith	30 m	Monumental at the parking terminus. Simple at the foot.
A2 Property Marker	12 m	Identifies a secondary entry from the approach.
A8 Tea House Marker	15 m	Visible from the road for route-side Chai; from the property path for in-house Chai.
A5 Directional Totem	8 m	Approached at walking pace at a path fork.
A3 Trail Signage	4 m	Ground-set; the walker is almost upon it.
A4 Cabin Number	1 m	Read at the threshold, hand height.
A11 Room Identity Plate	0.5 m	Read on the way in, interior, hand height.

CAP-HEIGHT FORMULA

Cap-height in mm = read distance in metres × 5 mm. Below 50 mm cap-height, lettering is functionally illegible at distance — and that may be the point. A signal of presence, not a label.

NO TWO DISTANCES ON ONE FACE

An artifact that reads at distance does not also detail at close range. The Monolith is monumental at 30 m and simple at the foot. We pick one.

NEVER

A sign that reads at 30 m and is also "decorative" at 1 m. A close-range artifact made oversized for prominence.

DOCTRINE B5 — LIGHT SPILL RULES

Light is for the guest's path. Not for the brand's visibility.

Light spill is pollution. We engineer it out.

SPILL LIMIT

Maximum 0.4 lux measured at 5 m from any artifact lighting source. The Monolith's floor-set lantern is calibrated to this. Path lanterns are calibrated to this.

NO UPWARD LIGHT

Full-cutoff fixtures everywhere. The canopy stays dark. The sky stays dark. Our dark-sky commitment is a standard, not a marketing claim.

NO WINDOW CONTAMINATION

Path lanterns positioned so that **no cabin's window receives direct illumination from any external source**. Walked at night by the property manager before sign-off.

FADES BY 30 M

Light at the property fades to dark within 30 m of the property line. The neighbouring village or forest does not receive Ekam light.

FULL-MOON TEST

During every site audit, the property is walked under full moon to confirm that human-made light reads less than natural light. If a lantern competes with moonlight, the lantern is dimmed or removed.

GOVERNS

A1 Monolith. A8 Tea House Markers. A14 Night Navigation. All cabin exterior lighting.

NEVER

Uplighting. Accent lighting. Wash lighting on buildings. Holiday lighting. Lanterns brighter than the moon.

DOCTRINE B6 — TYPOGRAPHY SCALE

Scale by read distance, surface, and tier.

Cap-height by artifact.

Cormorant Garamond Light 300 or Regular 400. Letterspacing 12% of cap-height on substrate; 8% on paper.

A1 Monolith	90 mm	CNC-routed, iron-inlaid.
A2 Property Marker	48 mm	CNC-routed, iron-inlaid.
A8 Tea House Marker	32 mm	CNC-routed, iron-inlaid.
A5 Directional Totem	28 mm	CNC-routed, iron-inlaid.
A11 Room Identity Plate	16 mm	CNC-routed, iron-inlaid.
A4 Cabin Number (Devanagari)	32 mm	Tiro Devanagari Hindi, hand-cut.

DISPLAY VS BODY

Cormorant for display, always. Raleway for body where any signage carries body copy (very rare — most signage carries a single name).

DEVANAGARI-LATIN PARITY

Devanagari cap-height matches Latin cap-height to within $\pm 5\%$. Visual balance is more important than mathematical equality.

EYEBROW TYPE

Inter 11 px, tracking 4 px, on the rare metadata plate. Never as primary lettering on a primary artifact.

NEVER

Bold weights. Italics on signage. Varied letter sizes within a single name. Decorative caps.

Monsoon, snow, and sun are the brand's co-designers.

MONSOON

Hardwood swells, then dries. We accept 1–2 mm of seasonal movement and design joinery to allow it. Iron darkens with humidity. We do not protect either.

SNOW (SHIKHAR & HIGH KUTIR)

Artifacts that disappear under snow are still present. The Monolith may stand half-buried in February; we do not clear it. Path lanterns are mounted high enough to clear typical seasonal snow accumulation per site spec.

SUMMER SUN

Hardwood silvers on south-facing surfaces faster than north. The differential is acceptable. We do not re-stain to match faces.

SPRING RE-EMERGENCE

Artifacts emerging from snow show salt-deposit lines and ice-cracking on softer woods. Repair with same-grain inset, never replace unless structurally compromised.

ANNUAL INSPECTION

Each site's property manager walks the artifact register annually. Damage register kept. Repair, not replace, where structurally possible.

GOVERNS

Every artifact in Annexure A.

NEVER

Tarp wraps in winter. Protective coatings applied between seasons. Replacement of weathered artifacts with new ones to "freshen up".

A ten-year-old Monolith should look
like ten years of Himalayan weather.
That is the point.

DOCTRINE B8 — MOUNTING SYSTEMS

The fastener is honest.

The mount belongs to the artifact's life, not to its installation.

IRON IN STONE

Iron pins set into stone with **lime mortar**. Never resin anchors. Never epoxy. The mortar lives and breathes with the stone.

HARDWOOD IN GROUND

Hardwood posts set in **gravel-packed footings**, not concrete. The post can be pulled and replaced; the ground recovers.

STONE, HALF-BURIED

Stone milestones, Silent Markers, Parking markers — half-buried. The buried mass is the anchor. No plinth. No pad. No footing.

WALL PLATES INSIDE THE CABIN

Attached with hand-set iron pins. Never modern screws with visible heads.

HIDDEN WHEN MODERN IS REQUIRED

Where modern fastenings are structurally required (under code, or at high-wind locations), the fastener is concealed **entirely**. We never show a half-honest fixing.

TRADE-BOUND

A mason sets stone. A carpenter sets wood. A smith sets iron. **We do not have a "signage installer."** We have these three trades, briefed.

NEVER

Visible Allen keys. Exposed screws. Brackets that read as inventory. Resin anchors anywhere.

When nature grows into the line of sight, nature wins.

A tree grew. A sign was placed. The tree was here first.

THE TREE WINS

When a tree grows into the sightline of a sign, **we do not prune the tree**. We re-locate the sign, or we let the obstruction stand as evidence that the land has acted on the artifact.

THE STONE WINS

When a stone shifts in monsoon and lands in front of a directional totem, the stone wins. We re-orient the totem if needed; the stone remains.

THE DRIFT IS THE SEASON

A snowdrift covers the Monolith from December through March. The drift is the season. **We do not clear it.**

THE NEST STAYS

A bird builds a nest in the lantern. The lantern is off for the season. We do not relocate the nest.

BIOLOGIST SIGN-OFF

The site's commissioned biologist signs off on any decision that would remove or alter a natural feature for signage. **By default, the answer is no.**

GOVERNS

Every artifact in Annexure A.

NEVER

Prune a tree to preserve a sightline. Move a stone for visibility. Clear snow off an artifact for "presentation". Photograph an artifact without its natural context.

DOCTRINE B10 — MULTILINGUAL HIERARCHY

Devanagari above. Latin below. Local script alongside, never instead.

Where script appears on Ekam signage in more than one writing system, the hierarchy is fixed. Devanagari sits above. Latin sits below. Where regional local script appears (Punjabi at Sangla, Tamil at a southern site), it sits below the Devanagari, paired but distinct.

DEVANAGARI ABOVE

Where both Devanagari and Latin appear — the Bilingual stack, the Monolith on bilingual sites, welcome cards — **Devanagari sits ABOVE the Latin.**

VERTICAL SPACING

Between scripts: equal to the cap-height of the larger script. The two scripts are paired, not crowded.

REGIONAL SCRIPT

Where the site demands regional script (Punjabi, Tamil, Marathi), it sits below the Devanagari, paired but distinct. English never replaces either.

WORDMARK

The Ekam wordmark itself is never set in Devanagari. एकम् is a companion to EKAM, not a substitute. The two appear together (Bilingual stack) or the wordmark appears alone in Latin.

MONOLITH

On a village-facing site, the Monolith may carry एकम् above the three-word lockup. On a non-village site, the lockup stands alone.

GOVERNS

A1 Monolith. A11 Room Identity Plate. Bilingual stack (Volume IV). Welcome cards (Volume VI).

NEVER

Hindi-Latin-English-Punjabi all on one sign. Devanagari below the Latin. Local script substituting for Devanagari. English-only signage at a site with a non-English-speaking village neighbour.

DOCTRINE B11 — REFLECTIVE BEHAVIOR AT NIGHT

The signage is matte. The night is dark.

Headlights at the parking terminus do not turn the property into a reflective grid.

IRON, MATTE

Oxidised iron is non-reflective by nature. **We do not polish it.** The headlight from the parking terminus reads the surface as a dark plane, not a mirror.

BRASS, OILED NOT LACQUERED

Brass is hand-oiled to a matte patina. Never lacquered. Lacquer catches light at predictable angles; oil does not.

STONE, UNSEALED

Unsealed stone holds water differently from sealed stone. A wet stone catches light, but it catches it diffusely and briefly. **This is part of the weather of the site.**

HARDWOOD, OILED NOT WAXED

Hand-oiled wood absorbs light. Waxed wood catches headlight glare and reads as a polished surface — a fail.

LANTERN GLASS

Hand-blown with slight irregularity. **Modern flat glass catches headlights and turns the lantern into a beacon.** Irregular hand-blown glass diffuses incoming light and reads as a soft glow.

COMPLIANCE EXCEPTION

A12 Emergency Signage is the only exception. Code-required reflectivity is permitted, named honestly, and confined to the compliance plate.

FULL-MOON TEST

During the site audit, the property is walked under full moon. **Any surface that catches more light than the surrounding land is refinished or replaced.**

NEVER

Polished metal. Sealed stone. Waxed wood. Flat machine-made glass on lanterns. Any reflective surface that competes with a headlight.

CLOSING THE ANNEXURE

A and B, applied together.

Annexure A and Annexure B are read in pairs. Before any artifact is commissioned, the site team walks through both — A to confirm the artifact type, B to confirm the behaviour. Every commissioned artifact is documented against the same checklist: which Annexure A type, what dimensions, what cap-height, where placed, how lit, how mounted, what spill measured, what hierarchy of script, what the property manager will inspect during the annual walk.

A site is in compliance with the Brand Operating System not when its signage exists, but when its signage **behaves** according to Annexure B. The audit checks behaviour, not presence.

A is what we build. B is how it lives.

THE TERMINUS

एकम्

E • KAM

Hospitality, disguised as solitude.

The most considered.

No two alike.

